

UNIV 301 – General Education ePortfolio

1 Unit

Instruction Mode & Meeting Times: Fully-Online, Asynchronous

7-Week Course | Spring 2026

Course Prerequisites

This course is for you if you have completed the following:

- UNIV 101: Introduction to the General Education Experience
- Your Foundations Writing and Math courses
- At least five of the seven Exploring Perspectives or Building Connections courses

Why the Course Prerequisites?

The purpose of the class is for you to think critically about your experiences in your Gen Ed courses at the UA. You will be expected to demonstrate the General Education Program Learning Outcomes using many Signature Assignments and Learning Artifacts added to your ePortfolio. Completing most of your general education is essential to having enough learning to remember, reflect on, and include in your ePortfolio. Students who are successful in this course have many learning artifacts to choose from, reflect on, and pull from their experiences because they have completed most of their general education courses.

That said, even if you have completed these prerequisites but do not feel like you have enough to include in your ePortfolio, you can always take this course in a future semester. This course is offered every fall, spring, and summer, every seven weeks.

Course Description, Course Objectives, and Learning Outcomes

Course Description

UNIV 301 is a 1-unit course designed for you to reflect upon and make meaning of your General Education experience through the refinement of your Gen Ed ePortfolio. This ePortfolio will include what you have learned throughout the General Education program and courses you have taken to date.

Course Objectives

What you can expect to do during UNIV 301:

- UNIV 301 gives you an opportunity to reflect and make meaning of your General Education experience at the University of Arizona.
- The course will complement and build off of your learning from UNIV 101 as well as the Gen Ed courses you have completed to date. You can then use these insights to describe the value your educational experience can offer future employers, graduate programs, and your community.
- It is designed to be one milestone along your learning journey at the University, marked by your academic, professional, and personal accomplishments. The course will include opportunities for you to communicate your academic and career interests and make a plan for your journey forward

as a lifelong learner.

- You will be curating your General Education ePortfolio, a collection of meaningful assignments and activities that showcase your educational career to date.

Expected Learning Outcomes

Your General Education experience is designed to help prepare you to approach complex issues and problems from an interdisciplinary perspective, an essential skill for any future career. After successfully completing this course you should expect to:

- Explain what you have learned from your General Education academic career (so you know why you have taken these courses)
- Make connections within your General Education courses as well as between your General Education courses and the rest of your undergraduate studies (so you can make meaning of what you have learned so far)
- Present what you have learned and how you have applied these insights through your General Education studies (so you can communicate the value of your educational experience to various audiences)
- Define your goals for future personal, academic, and professional growth as you complete your degree (so you feel confident with your plans as a lifelong learner moving forward)

Meet Your Instructor

Jessica Hill, EdD she/her/hers Assistant Professor of Practice UNIV Core Faculty Office of General Education W.A. Franke Honors College	Email: crombie@arizona.edu Student Hours: Schedule by appointment at: https://calendly.com/jessicahill234/univ301 <i>All course information is available on D2L (Brightspace)</i>
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About the Instructor

Prior to joining the University of Arizona community, Dr. Hill received her M.A. in Higher Education Student Affairs Administration from Ball State University and a B.A. from the University of Wisconsin at Madison in English, Communication Arts – Rhetoric Studies, and Women's Studies. She joined the University of Arizona as a staff member in 2007. In 2022, she finished her doctorate in Educational Leadership & Innovation at Arizona State University. Over her career at the UA, she has enjoyed managing a residence hall, advising student organizations, teaching courses, facilitating workshops, and creating new leadership development experiences for undergraduate students. Her research interests focus on the use of games, play, and improv comedy practices to develop the critical leadership skills of group creativity.

Course Communication and Course Format

Communication in Our Course

It is important that we keep up-to-date with any course-related information, as communication may directly impact your success in the course. Any communications for the entire class will be posted in the announcements section on the homepage of the course site, which you should check regularly throughout the week.

When entering grades for your submitted work, the instructor will often enter comments for you to read. These comments live within the gradebook in Brightspace — please click on the comments icon to read them. It is a reasonable expectation that the instructor will carefully review your assignments; likewise, it is a reasonable expectation that you carefully review feedback provided on your assignments.

Another tool used to communicate with you directly is email through Brightspace. It is important to practice checking your UA email account regularly (once per day, at minimum).

If you are feeling stuck and have exhausted the communication strategies mentioned here, please reach out by email. Contact information is available in the Meet Your Instructor course file.

Course Format

This course is fully online and includes asynchronous activities (activities you complete on your own time by a specific date), including readings, videos, ePortfolio development, discussion posts, and Playposit videos. The class will not meet online or in-person on a specific day/time unless you attend student hours.

You should plan to be an active participant throughout the online activities, which means watching and interacting with all content, bringing your own ideas, asking questions, contributing to class discussions, and workshopping your ePortfolio by the due dates in the course schedule.

Course Textbook and Materials

Course Textbook: Wildcat Reflections

Thomas, Devon L., Thomas A. Murray, Sovay M. Hansen, and Ryan Winet, editors. *Wildcat Reflections*. The University of Arizona, 2022.

This is an Open Education Resource, which means there is no additional cost to you. The book is available for free online and links to the weekly readings will be provided in each module.

Course Technology: Digication

In order to document and reflect upon your entire Gen Ed experience, you will be creating an ePortfolio using a system called Digication. You can, and should, use the ePortfolio you started in UNIV 101: Introduction to the General Education Experience. There is no cost to use this system. In this class, you will be logging into Digication, making edits to your ePortfolio each week, and sharing the link to your peers for feedback.

Digication: <https://arizona.digication.com/app/>

Grading and Class Participation Policies

Class Participation Policy

Students who are successful in this course establish regular habits for completing their online work and communicate with their colleagues and instructors when they feel stuck or need help. For this class, success looks like logging into the Brightspace site at least three times per week, completing the activities in the module associated with that week (including readings, videos, reading reflections, class discussions, and other activities) before they are due, and responding to feedback provided by colleagues and the instructor.

Students not participating in class at the beginning of a term may be administratively dropped from the class by the instructor. Students not submitting work for the first two weeks may be administratively dropped at the instructor's discretion. The UA's policy concerning Class Attendance, Participation, and Administrative Drops is available at: <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-participation-and-administrative-drop>

Submitting Your Work

You will have a variety of assignments to submit for this class, described in the Assignments module. For all assignments, you should be submitting original work. Please be sure to familiarize yourself with the UA Code of Academic Integrity. Submitting unoriginal work, including work generated using AI, is not permitted in this class.

For many assignments, you will be submitting your work in an assignment folder in Digication. You are responsible for checking that your work was uploaded and submitted correctly for your instructor to evaluate.

Late Policy

Class participation through discussion boards and course assignments are designed to support your learning, which is why these learning activities are associated with your overall grade.

For the first week of class — which includes the Syllabus Quiz, the Gen Ed ePortfolio Playposit, and the first Reading Reflection — you will have a **two-day grace period**. These three assignments can be submitted up to two days late without losing points. Because we are all participating in a discussion together, **discussion board work may not be submitted late**.

After these three assignments, the following late penalties apply:

- Assignments submitted up to 24 hours late: 25% deduction
- Assignments submitted 24–48 hours late: 50% deduction
- Assignments submitted more than 48 hours late: no credit, except in documented extenuating circumstances communicated before the deadline

Grading Scale

This is a regularly graded course. Your final grade is determined by your demonstration of the learning outcomes of the course. You have the opportunity to earn up to **1,000 points**.

Grade	Points
A (Excellent)	900 or more points
B (Good)	800–899 points
C (Satisfactory)	700–799 points

D (Poor)	600–699 points
E (Failure)	Fewer than 599 points

Assignment Points Distribution

Assignment	Points
Syllabus Quiz	50
Class Participation (Discussion Posts, 6 x 50 pts)	300
Reading Reflections (4 x 50 pts)	200
Gen Ed ePortfolio Playposit	50
Rough Draft of ePortfolio	100
Lifelong Learning Journey Presentation	100
Final ePortfolio	200
Total	1,000

Requests for incomplete (I) or withdrawal (W) must be made in accordance with University grading policies, available in the University Catalog.

If you do not agree with the grade and feedback provided on your assignment, you have one week from the time feedback is posted to meet with the instructor to discuss your grade.

Online Classroom

Online Engagement & Communication

The assumption that online courses are composed of individual students working in isolation is not the case. In an online classroom, plan for three key points of engagement:

- Student to Content
- Student to Student
- Student to Instructor

Mindful Communication

The two major components of communication are listening and speaking. Bringing mindfulness to bear on these in an online conversation includes being willing to stay open and curious. Before contributing to a conversation in this course, ask yourself:

- Is it true?
- Is it kind?
- Is it helpful?
- Is it necessary?

Online Communication Expectations (Netiquette)

Netiquette refers to guidelines for communicating online to ensure meaningful and polite exchanges. The following standards apply to both the online classroom and professional online communication:

- **Behavior.** Maintain the same standard of behavior and ethics that you would follow in a face-to-face context.
- **Tone.** Treat others with respect. Be mindful of your tone and how it is conveyed in your writing. Do not use ALL CAPS (it is considered shouting). Avoid sarcasm and irony, which are easily misinterpreted online.
- **Clarity and Content.** Be succinct. Write, reread, then post. Does your post make sense? Is it free from errors? Does it add to the conversation?
- **Contribute.** Online learning is not passive. Share your knowledge and insight and be an active contributor to the learning community.
- **Be forgiving.** If someone makes a mistake, address it privately and politely, or let the instructor know.

Tips for Discussions

Discussion tools will frequently be used both to connect with fellow students and as a format for graded assessments. Before contributing, consider whether you have adequately addressed the prompt, aligned your work to the rubric, and edited for content and clarity.

Communicating With Your Instructor

Regular contact with your instructor is incredibly important to your success in an online course. Ask questions as they arise, making sure to follow the preferred methods outlined in the syllabus. Speaking up and soliciting feedback will keep you on track and help you avoid common pitfalls.

Catmail

You are required to use your University of Arizona email account for any course-related email communication to ensure your privacy. Please check your UA email (Catmail) regularly — that is how your instructor may choose to notify you of approaching due dates, course announcements, grades, or other private, course-related information.

University of Arizona Syllabus Policies

The University of Arizona's standard syllabus policies — including policies on attendance, academic integrity, accessibility and accommodations, nondiscrimination and anti-harassment, threatening behavior, preferred pronouns, confidentiality of student records, and the subject to change statement — apply to this course.

These policies are available in full at: <https://catalog.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>

University of Arizona Indigenous Land Acknowledgement

We respectfully acknowledge the University of Arizona is on the land and territories of Indigenous peoples. Today, Arizona is home to 22 federally recognized tribes, with Tucson being home to the O'odham and the Yaqui. Committed to diversity and inclusion, the University strives to build sustainable relationships with sovereign Native Nations and Indigenous communities through education offerings,

partnerships, and community service.

Additional Resources for Students

- **Campus Health:** <http://www.health.arizona.edu/> | Phone: 520-621-9202
- **Counseling and Psych Services (CAPS):** <https://health.arizona.edu/counseling-psych-services> | Phone: 520-621-3334
- **Dean of Students – Student Assistance:**
<https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/support/student-assistance> | Phone: 520-621-7057 | Email: DOS-deanofstudents@arizona.edu
- **Survivor Advocacy Program:** <https://survivoradvocacy.arizona.edu/> | Phone: 520-621-5767 | Email: survivoradvocacy@arizona.edu
- **Campus Pantry:** <https://campuspantry.arizona.edu/>
- **Disability Resource Center:** 520-621-3268 | <https://drc.arizona.edu/>
- **UA Academic Policies and Procedures:** <https://catalog.arizona.edu/policies>